

Health Education Program Plan: Managing Type 2 Diabetes in Seniors

Step 1: Program Foundation and Demographic Profile

To establish a robust health education program, the foundational parameters must be defined to align with public health standards for geriatric chronic disease management.

Overall Goal of the Program: To empower seniors with Type 2 Diabetes to improve glycemic control and self-management efficacy through evidence-based nutritional, physical, and pharmacological education.

Audience Description: Adults aged 65+ residing in suburban or urban communities. The demographic includes individuals recently diagnosed with Type 2 Diabetes or those struggling with long-term management. Consideration is given to varying levels of health literacy and potential age-related mobility or sensory impairments.

Ideal Number of Participants: 15 to 20 individuals (to facilitate group interaction while allowing for individualized attention).

Location/Setting: Local Community Health Center or Senior Activity Center with accessible facilities and audiovisual capabilities.

Step 2: Program Plan Outline - Weeks 1 to 6

The program is structured over six weeks, building knowledge and skills progressively.

Week 1: Diabetes Foundations & Physiology

Topics: Pathophysiology of Type 2 Diabetes, understanding blood glucose ranges, and identifying symptoms of hyper/hypoglycemia.

SMART Objective 1: By the end of the session, 90% of participants will be able to correctly identify the target fasting blood glucose range as defined by the American Diabetes Association (ADA).

SMART Objective 2: Participants will be able to list at least three common symptoms of hypoglycemia (e.g., shakiness, sweating, confusion) and the "15-15 Rule" for treatment by the end of the class.

Week 2: Nutritional Management & The Plate Method

Topics: Macronutrients, carbohydrate counting, reading nutrition labels, and the "Diabetes Plate Method."

SMART Objective 1: Participants will accurately demonstrate how to use the "Diabetes Plate Method" to plan a balanced meal during an interactive activity.

SMART Objective 2: By the end of the session, 75% of participants will be able to correctly identify the serving size and carbohydrate content on a provided nutrition label.

Week 3: Physical Activity for Glycemic Control

Topics: Benefits of exercise for Type 2 Diabetes, safe exercise guidelines, and incorporating daily physical activity.

SMART Objective 1: Participants will be able to describe at least three benefits of regular physical activity for managing Type 2 Diabetes.

SMART Objective 2: By the end of the session, participants will commit to trying at least one new physical activity shown in class (e.g., chair exercises, walking routine) in the coming week.

Week 4: Medication Management & Adherence

Topics: Common oral medications and insulin, proper administration techniques, and importance of adherence.

SMART Objective 1: Participants will be able to correctly identify the purpose and common side effects of their prescribed diabetes medication(s).

SMART Objective 2: Participants will accurately demonstrate the correct technique for administering insulin (if applicable) or using a pill organizer during a practical demonstration.

Week 5: Monitoring & Problem Solving

Topics: Blood glucose monitoring (SMBG), interpreting results, sick day management, and foot care.

SMART Objective 1: By the end of the session, 80% of participants will be able to correctly interpret a given blood glucose reading (e.g., high, low, target).

SMART Objective 2: Participants will be able to list at least three actions to take during a "sick day" to manage their diabetes effectively.

Week 6: Long-Term Complications & Support Systems

Topics: Understanding and preventing long-term complications, stress management, and identifying community resources.

SMART Objective 1: Participants will be able to name at least two long-term complications of uncontrolled diabetes and strategies for prevention.

SMART Objective 2: By the end of the program, participants will identify at least two local or online support resources for individuals with Type 2 Diabetes.